



After Being Convicted Of Voting In The 1872 Presidential Election🧑🏻‍🦱🗳️🔗Skill. Technical Language.

Assigned by: Mr. A

Due: Oct 21, 2024 11:59 PM

 Learning Objectives
Text

1.

★
DEFINE

2.

🔄
MODEL

3.

🔄
YOUR TURN

Define



Scene Description

Two students sit side by side in a classroom. They talk directly into the camera.

Transcript

00:00 (INTRODUCTION PLAYS)

00:05 ALICIA: There's more to understanding a word than learning it's definition.

00:08 BEN: There is? ALICIA: Yes. There is a word's connotation.

00:12 BEN: Oh yes! There is.

00:14 ALICIA: A word's connotation is its emotional or cultural connection.

00:22 Words can have a positive, negative, or neutral connotations,

00:25 outside of the literal definition.

00:28 BEN: Hey look-- I have a moustache!

00:30 ALICIA: The word "child" for example.

00:32 By definition, a young person.

00:34 But when a teenager or adult is called a child,

00:38 the word takes on a negative connotation.

00:42 BEN: Well, okay...Uh...Point is, readers need to be aware

00:46 that words can have emotional as well as literal meanings.

00:49 ALICIA: Right, which is where the context of the word comes in.

00:52 Readers use context to determine how a word is being used.

01:00 BEN: At the end of the day,

01:01 it's all about understanding the author's intent, people.

01:05 Remember that! ALICIA: Now let's sum it up.

Every word has a literal or an exact meaning that appears in the dictionary. But in addition to these dictionary definitions, some words also have what are called an implied or associated meaning. The *denotation* of a word refers to its literal meaning, while the *connotation* of a word is based on the association it has for many people, depending on its context, or how it is used. For example, the denotation of the word *greasy* is simply “covered with oil,” when it’s used to describe a car engine or a door hinge. But when *greasy* is used to describe someone’s hair or a platter of food, it takes on a negative connotation.

CA-CCSS: 📍 CA.L.9-10.5b, CA.RI.9-10.4

CA-ELD: 📍 ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Ex



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Model

AUDIO ANNOTATION VIEW ALL NUMBERS

1 Identification and Application:

- Denotation is the dictionary definition of a word.
- Connotation refers to the emotions or associations a word may have for many people, even if they are not the same as the word's exact meaning.
- Connotations may be either positive or negative, depending on the context. For example, saying that someone's clothes look "interesting" may be interpreted as either a negative or positive comment.
- When you're looking at connotative and denotative meanings, it's important to remember that authors make specific, intentional choices with the words they use.
 - Authors use the exact, or denotative, meaning of a word to construct literal meaning.
 - Authors use connotations associated with some words to create a certain meaning, theme, or tone.
 - Authors use nuances—or subtle differences in the meanings of words with similar denotations—to create figurative meanings.
- If you don't know the precise meaning or connotation of a word, first try to figure it out from the context, and then check your guess in a dictionary.

2 Model:

In 1872, Susan B. Anthony moved from district to district in New York, delivering her speech, "After Being Convicted of Voting in the 1872 Presidential Election." In her speech, she tried to convince citizens that women not only should have the right to vote, but also under the Constitution, already had the right. She made very intentional language choices, choosing words whose connotations created a specific tone and enhanced her argument. Consider the first paragraph of her speech:

- 3 Friends and fellow citizens: I stand before you tonight under indictment for the **alleged** crime of having voted at the last presidential election, without having a lawful right to vote. It shall be my work this evening to prove to you that in thus voting, I not only committed no crime, but, instead, simply exercised my citizen's rights, guaranteed to me and all United States citizens by the National Constitution, beyond the power of any state to deny. ...
- 4 The denotation of the word "alleged" in the speech's first paragraph is that of "describing an accusation or claim made without proof." The connotation of "alleged" in this context is negative, suggesting that her supposed crime is no crime at all. She could have chosen synonyms such as "supposed," "so-called," or "purported." None of these, however, have the biting nuance that "alleged" has. Through the connotation of the word, Anthony is furthering her point that it is ridiculous that women do not have the right to vote. She continues in the fourth paragraph:
- 5 It was we, the people; not we, the white male citizens; nor yet we, the male citizens; but we, the whole people, who formed the Union. And we formed it, not to give the blessings of liberty, but to secure them; not to the half of ourselves and the half of our posterity, but to the whole people—women as well as men. And it is a downright **mockery** to talk to women of their enjoyment of the blessings of liberty while they are denied the use of the only means of securing them provided by this democratic-republican government—the ballot. ...
- 6 The denotation of the word "mockery" as it is used in the speech is that of "teasing or hateful language or behavior directed at someone." The connotation of "mockery" in this speech is negative, impassioned, and angry. Anthony is condemning those who would deprive women the right to vote. Anthony makes a very specific, intentional word choice here, picking "mockery" instead of synonyms such as "joke," "parody," or "farce." "Mockery" is more forceful. The other words, though they have a very similar denotation, do not have the angry, condemning nuance that the word "mockery" has. Through her word choice, she is underscoring the painful absurdity of the idea that women cannot yet vote.
- 7 Over the course of the speech, these small, intentional language choices accumulate to deliver the full force of her passion, knowledge, and outrage to the reader. In this way, Susan B. Anthony increases the emotional force of her speech and the strength of her persuasive argument.

CA-CCSS: 📌 CA.L.9-10.5b, CA.RI.9-10.4

CA-ELD: 📌 ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Ex



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Your Turn

Read this section (paragraph 6) from “After Being Convicted of Voting in the 1872 Presidential Election” to identify connotation and denotation. Then answer the follow-up questions.

It is not a republic. It is an odious aristocracy; a hateful oligarchy of sex; the most hateful aristocracy ever established on the face of the globe; an oligarchy of wealth, where the rich govern the poor. An oligarchy of learning, where the educated govern the ignorant, or even an oligarchy of race, where the Saxon rules the African, might be endured; but this oligarchy of sex, which makes father, brothers, husband, sons, the oligarchs over the mother and sisters, the wife and daughters, of every household—which ordains all men sovereigns, all women subjects, carries dissension, discord, and rebellion into every home of the nation.

CA-CCSS: 📌 CA.L.9-10.5b, CA.RI.9-10.4
CA-ELD: 📌 ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.b.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.6.c.Ex, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Br, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Em, ELD.PI.9-10.8.Ex

Part A

What is the connotation of the word “odious” as it is used in the second sentence of the excerpt?

- ☐ A. Extremely repellent; completely offensive
- ☐ B. Related to the family
- ☐ C. Ruled by the few
- ☐ D. Smelly; decaying

Part B

Which of Anthony’s arguments does this connotation of “odious” support?

- ☐ A. Women should hold the same political offices as men.
- ☐ B. It is intolerable to have one sex govern the other.
- ☐ C. The inability to vote rots in a woman’s heart.
- ☐ D. Women should be guaranteed the same educational opportunities as those of men.

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